

Graduate Research Assistant Position

Project: Cannabis Policy and Health Behaviors

Contact Information

Tiffanie Perrault

Assistant Professor of Economics

Seidman College of Business, Grand Valley State University

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Terms

This is a full-time Graduate Assistant (GA) position (20 hours per week) starting on August 25, 2025, and ending on May 2, 2026. This position includes 30 weeks of work at 20 hours per week (600 total hours) and offers a stipend of \$13,000 (\$6,500 per semester, Fall and Winter) along with an 18-credit tuition waiver (9 credits per semester, Fall and Winter). This position is open to full-time students only.

Responsibilities

- Clean, integrate, and manage datasets, including the ATUS and state-level cannabis policy and black-market pricing data. (25%)
- Conduct exploratory data analysis to identify patterns and trends in health behaviors and market outcomes. (20%)
- Assist in the development and estimation of econometric models to disentangle the direct and indirect effects of cannabis legalization policies on health behaviors. (20%)
- Research and synthesize cannabis legalization policies across U.S. states, focusing on variations in taxation, regulation, and market structure. (15%)
- Collaborate with the supervisor to prepare drafts of research findings, including tables, figures, and preliminary interpretations. (15%)
- Contribute to the preparation of a research poster or presentation for academic forums. (5%)

Learning Outcomes

- Develop advanced skills in data cleaning, statistical modeling, and quantitative research methods using Stata or Python.
- Gain hands-on experience with interdisciplinary research at the intersection of public health, economics, and policy analysis.
- Strengthen communication skills through research synthesis and academic writing.
- Enhance problem-solving and critical-thinking skills in data-driven policy research.

Qualifications

- Must be fully admitted to a GVSU graduate degree program, preferably in economics, data science, public health, epidemiology, or any other related field, and in good academic standing, i.e. must have, and maintain throughout length of GA contract, a 3.0 or higher GPA.
- Proficiency in statistical software (e.g., R, Stata, or Python) and familiarity with quantitative methods.
- Strong organizational skills and attention to detail for managing large datasets.
- Interest in policy research, public health, and economic analysis.
- Ability to work independently while maintaining regular communication with the supervisor.

Workstation

The graduate assistant will work from an open space adjacent to faculty offices on the downtown campus. Within this space, they will have a shared PC available.

Orientation

A brief orientation will be provided at the start of the appointment by Tiffanie Perrault, the primary supervisor. This orientation will cover key expectations, including the graduate assistant's time commitment, policies on outside employment, and professional standards. Informal guidance and support will be provided throughout the appointment as needed. The graduate assistant will also be required to attend the mandatory New Graduate Assistant Orientation, Friday, August 22, 2025, 3:00-4:00pm in Loosemore Auditorium on the downtown Pew campus.

Supervision

The graduate assistant will report to Tiffanie Perrault, Assistant Professor of Economics in the Seidman College of Business. The graduate assistant will receive guidance at least once a week and will have a more formal and extensive review at least once a month.

Selection Process

Submit your cover letter and resume via Workday.
No reference letters are required.

Deadline to Apply

June 1, 2025, or until filled.